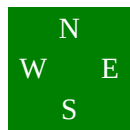


Board 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 10 6
♥ 8
♦ K J 9 4
♣ J 10 8 5

♠ A K 4 3
♥ A 5 2
♦ A 7 6 2
♣ K 4



♠ 8 7 5
♥ 9 7 4
♦ Q 10 5
♣ A Q 7 3

♠ 9 2
♥ K Q J 10 6 3
♦ 8 3
♣ 9 6 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	4♥		2♥
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

Wow! Partner opens with a 2-bid and you have all of this?

Don't get carried away, it was a **WEAK** 2-bid. So even though you have 19 points partner has only 6-11. But even though it is possible that the total only comes to 25 you bid the game anyway, figuring that it will probably be at least 26.

North would play 4♥.

Click

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠Q.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠Q.

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 3 : Total = 4

There are two ways to get rid of one of those ♣ losers. You can lead up to the ♣K, hoping that West holds ♣A, or you can ruff it in dummy.

Suppose you try to combine both chances. Win the ♠K, then play a small ♥ to your hand. Lead a ♣ and play dummy's ♣K. East takes the ♣A and plays another trump which you win in your hand. You play another ♣ but East wins this one also and leads another trump, removing dummy's last hope of ruffing a ♣. Down 1.

Instead you could give up on the idea of leading toward the ♣K and just lead a ♣ from dummy at trick 2. The defenders can win and lead a trump, but you play a second ♣. They win this also but even if they lead a trump you can still ruff your third ♣ in dummy and make the game.

You can see that playing a ♣ from dummy will guarantee the contract.

You can also see that leading a ♥ back to your hand at trick 2 is a bad idea.

But did you see there is another way to reach your hand? You could play ♠A then ruff a ♠. This runs the small risk that East started with a singleton ♠.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

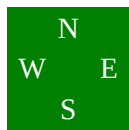
♠ 7 5 3
♥ Q 10 7 6
♦ K Q J
♣ Q 10 8

♠ Q 9 2

♥ 8 5 4

♦ A 6 3

♣ 7 5 4 2



♠ A 6

♥ J 9

♦ 10 8 7 4 2

♣ K J 9 3

♠ K J 10 8 4

♥ A K 3 2

♦ 9 5

♣ A 6

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♦
Pass	3 ♠		
All Pass			
3 ♠ by South			

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 5

The ♦ loser, the ♣ loser and the Ace of trumps are unavoidable. One ♥ loser is also unavoidable, but the second one can be ruffed in dummy. You cannot afford to play a single trump.

Win the ♦ A and play ♥ A, ♥ K, ♥ 2. The defenders will win this. If your ♥ 3 happened to set up then you won't have to ruff it, but more than likely the ♥ s split 4-2. The defenders may now take a ♦ winner, or they may lead ♠ A and another ♠. But they cannot stop you from ruffing your fourth ♥ with dummy's ♠ Q or ♠ 9.

The defenders may not lead trumps to try to stop your ruff.

In that case you must be sure to ruff the fourth ♥ with the ♠ Q or the ♠ 9. If East wants to over-ruff it will be with the ♠ A which you must lose anyway.

Look at what would have happened if you had led a trump at trick 2. East could have won the ♠ A and played another ♠. Then, when West took the third ♥ he could lead his last ♠ and dummy would have no trump to ruff the final ♥ with.

With 6 points you must respond. And with 3 ♠ s you can support partner's suit.

You respond 2 ♠ and partner bids 3 ♦.

Partner's 3 ♦ bid is a Help Suit Game Try. He is inviting you to bid game if you have a good 2 ♠ response, particularly if you can help him in ♦ s.

Although have the ♦ help you have a bare minimum response. So you return to 3 ♠ which partner passes.

North would play 3 ♠.

Click

South plays 3 ♠. West leads the ♦ K.

South plays 3 ♠. West leads the ♦ K.